

COVER EMAIL — paste into your reply to Noah Wild-Hebbs (noah.wildhebbbs@parliament.uk)
Subject: RE: Splink / MoJ "probation-to-police" pilot — briefing, FOIs & draft questions

Dear Noah,

Thank you — and please pass my thanks to Mr Mohamed. That the office asked the Home Office WPQs on the DPIAs for the Palantir trial is exactly the kind of scrutiny this needs, and I'm glad to help take it further on the MoJ side.

I've put together a short parliamentary briefing pack. It's attached/below in four parts:

1. **Briefing note** — what the MoJ "probation-to-police" pilot actually is, drawn entirely from the MoJ's *own* published Algorithmic Transparency Record, with the consent/legal-basis gap set out plainly.
2. **Draft Written Parliamentary Questions to the MoJ** — 16 questions, written to be specific and answerable (and to make a non-answer conspicuous), grouped by theme. Use, cut or re-word freely.
3. **FOI requests** — the text I've used / would use with the MoJ, plus a note on the parallel request I have open with the Australian Bureau of Statistics on the same software, which is useful as international corroboration.
4. **Evidence annex** — every factual claim with its primary source (mostly the government's own gov.uk transparency records), and a note on where the full archived evidence lives.

One distinction worth holding onto, because it makes the questions land:

- **Splink** is the **Ministry of Justice's** own open-source record-linkage tool. It is what drives the "probation-to-police" pilot (and JustLink, and the real-time "Core Person Record"). MoJ questions.
- **Palantir** is a **separate, US-owned commercial platform** (the FDP / the Home Office trial you already asked about). Home Office / DHSC questions.

They are *not* the same system and there is no documented technical link between them — I'm careful never to claim otherwise. They are two layers of the same "joining-up" of citizen data, in different departments. Keeping them apart is what stops the Government deflecting a Splink question by answering about Palantir, or vice versa.

Everything here is built from public documents — no non-public system was accessed — and every claim is graded by how well it's evidenced. Where something is a *pilot* rather than a national rollout, or where the legal basis is implied rather than stated, I've flagged it as such; I'd rather under-claim than hand the department an easy rebuttal.

I'd be glad to help refine the questions, suggest follow-ups once the answers come back (WPQ answers are often evasive — the value is frequently in what they *won't* confirm), or walk through any

of the sourcing with you. The full nine-part investigation and evidence repository are linked in the annex.

Thank you again for taking this seriously.

Best, Bran (Brandon) Myers brandonmyers.net